

PMD · Build-in-Public Content Strategy

Artifact #19 · v1.0 · May 2026 · PMD System · The Atom-to-Architecture Framework

SYSTEM PURPOSE

What this is	The PMD Build-in-Public Content Strategy — the system for converting every project's raw work product into a compounding library of published proof. It operates on a single principle: every decision made during the PMD process is content. The discipline of writing about what was built and why compresses skill development faster than building in silence.
Why it exists	A portfolio without a publishing trail is invisible. This system creates a trail of documented thinking that accumulates across every project. By the time the first portfolio milestone project ships, the publishing record already demonstrates pattern recognition, PM fluency, and technical depth — without waiting for a job offer to prove any of it.
How it integrates	Content generation is not a separate task. It is the final step of every PMD project phase. The retro artifact generates the raw material. The Artifact-to-Draft Pipeline converts that raw material into publishable content. The three-tier distribution system places that content where evaluators look.
The model name	The Atom-to-Architecture Framework — also described as Create Once, Distribute Thrice. Small granular build log posts (atoms) aggregate into insight pillars, which aggregate into executive case studies (architecture). No piece of content is created in isolation.
PMD integration point	This artifact is a permanent PMD system process. Every project from P1 forward generates at least one Tier-1 Build Log post. Every phase group closure generates at least one Tier-2 Insight Pillar. Every portfolio milestone project generates a Tier-3 Executive Case Study.

THE THREE-TIER FRAMEWORK — OVERVIEW

Tier	Name	Length	Cadence	Platform	Primary Goal	CTA
1	Build Log	150–300 words or 3–5 threads	2–3× per week	LinkedIn Feed X.com Site Changelog	Velocity & Visibility Profile impressions Search recruiter reach	"Follow for the next update"
2	Insight Pillar	600–1,000 words	1–2× per month	Medium Substack LinkedIn Articles	Authority & Depth Domain credibility Network growth	"Subscribe for deeper dives"
3	Executive Case Study	1,500–2,500 words visual-heavy	Once per portfolio project	Portfolio site (canonical) Resume attachment	Recruiter conversion Interview booking Hiring manager depth	"Download the full PDF case study"

Tier 1 THE BUILD LOG — Social Proof in Real Time

Voice: Real-time · Transparent · Technical · "The Hustle"

The Build Log is the atomic unit of the entire system. It documents a single, highly granular technical or product decision made during a PMD project phase. It does not need to be polished — it needs to be honest, specific, and publishable within 30 minutes of the decision being made. The raw material comes directly from the PMD project retrospective and decision logs. A Tier-1 post that performs well becomes the seed for a Tier-2 Insight Pillar.

Attribute	Detail
Scope	Single granular decision, trade-off, failure, or micro-observation. One decision per post. No summaries.
Platforms	LinkedIn Feed (Quick Update format) · X.com (thread or single post) · On-site product changelog
SEO & Hooks	Niche technical keywords · Tool tags (e.g., #Supabase #React #NextJS) · 'Building in Public' community hashtags · First 100 characters optimized to stop scrolling
PMD Source	PMD Retrospective artifact · Decision log section · Failure/Pivot log · Session notes

POST STRUCTURE

Section	What to Write
THE CHALLENGE	A crisp one or two sentence hook describing the exact bottleneck or decision point encountered.
CRITERIA & CONSTRAINTS	The technical, time, API, or architectural limits that shaped the decision space.
THE CHOICE	The exact path chosen and the viable alternative that was actively rejected — with explicit rationale.
THE SIGNAL	The positive outcome, metric improvement, or learning point that resulted. Even a failure is a valid signal.

Tier 2 THE INSIGHT PILLAR — The 'How I Think' Series

Voice: Educational · Authoritative · Analytical · "The Analyst & Leader"

The Insight Pillar synthesizes three to five Tier-1 Build Log posts into a single thematic framework article. The shift is from 'I did X' to 'How a PM manages Y.' It demonstrates pattern recognition — the ability to extract a generalizable principle from a set of specific decisions. Insight Pillars are the primary source of LinkedIn profile authority and the primary driver of Medium and Substack readership. A strong Tier-2 article can be de-bulked into five sequential LinkedIn posts over a single week to maximize profile impressions with minimal additional writing effort. This is the Hidden SEO tactic.

Attribute	Detail
Scope	Theme across 3–5 Tier-1 posts. One unifying framework per article. Generalizable to other PMs.
Platforms	Medium · Substack · LinkedIn Articles (canonical) · De-bulked into 5x LinkedIn Feed posts
SEO & Hooks	Mid-tail keywords: 'Product Management for Startups' · 'Scaling Next.js Architecture' · Deep-link CTAs to portfolio
PMD Source	Cluster of 3–5 retrospective entries from one phase or across adjacent phases · Phase-close session summary

POST STRUCTURE

Section	What to Write
COMPELLING TITLE	Format: 'Designing [System Type]: How to Navigate the Trade-offs of [Theme]'
THE HOOK	Why this problem matters to PMs broadly — not just to this project.
THE FRAMEWORK	Three to five clearly-labeled subsections. Each maps one Tier-1 decision to a generalizable principle.
THE TAKEAWAY	An explicit, copyable framework statement. What can another PM do with this tomorrow?

Tier 3 THE EXECUTIVE CASE STUDY — The Closer

Voice: Strategic · High-level · ROI-focused · "The Principal PM"

The Executive Case Study is the primary conversion artifact. It is placed on the portfolio site as the canonical document for every portfolio milestone project. It is attached directly to job applications and shared with recruiters post-screening. It must survive two reading modes simultaneously: a 2-minute recruiter skim using scannable headers and metric callouts, and a 10-minute hiring manager deep dive using detailed architecture sections, tradeoff documentation, and outcome data. Every PMD portfolio milestone project produces one Tier-3 case study. The five-part structure maps directly to the PMD artifact suite already produced during the project's nine-phase cycle.

Attribute	Detail
Scope	Full project lifecycle. Problem through outcome. All tradeoffs documented. Visual-heavy with artifact embeds.
Platforms	Portfolio site (canonical) · Attached to resume · Forwarded to recruiters post-screening
SEO & Hooks	High-intent recruiter keywords · Scannable headers for 2-min skim · Data sections for 10-min deep dive
PMD Source	All nine PMD phase artifacts for the project · Problem Statement · Personas · PRD · Wireframe · Retro · Launch Plan · Measure Plan

POST STRUCTURE

Section	What to Write
EXECUTIVE SUMMARY	Core ROI and metric highlights. What was built, what moved, why it matters. Skim-readable in 90 seconds.
MARKET OPPORTUNITY & PROBLEM VALIDATION	The discovery journey. Research, personas, competitive analysis, and problem framing.
THE ARCHITECTURAL BLUEPRINT	Tech stack choices, database structures, API architecture, and the rationale for each decision.
THE ENGINEERING CRUX & PIVOTS	Where the initial plan failed and how it was steered. Tradeoffs documented explicitly. No sanitizing.
OUTCOMES, ANALYTICS & NEXT STEPS	User metrics, performance data, what was learned, and what Phase 2 would address.

THE ARTIFACT-TO-DRAFT PIPELINE

Raw project notes are the raw material. The PMD artifact suite is the assembly line. The AI generates first drafts. The human refines and publishes. This pipeline converts every PMD project into a content inventory without requiring a separate content creation workflow. Notes from the session, the decision log, the retro, and the phase summary are all eligible inputs. Categorize all raw notes into four buckets before drafting.

FOUR RAW MATERIAL BUCKETS — CATEGORIZE NOTES HERE FIRST

Bucket	What Goes Here	Maps to PMD Artifact	Best Tier Output
Decision Logs	The 'why' behind every tool, architecture, or scope choice. Rejected alternatives documented.	PRD Section 5 · Technical Requirements · Documented Tradeoffs	Tier 1 & Tier 3
Failure / Pivot Logs	Moments the plan broke. What failed, what was learned, and the adjustment made.	Retrospective · 'What to improve' · 'Questions still open'	Tier 1 & Tier 3
Metric Logs	Before/after comparisons. Performance benchmarks. Conversion changes. Lighthouse scores.	Measure & Iterate Plan · OKR KR tracking · A/B test results	Tier 2 & Tier 3
User / Persona Logs	Moments user feedback changed a design decision. JTBD insights. Empathy map observations.	Persona artifact · Empathy Map · JTBD + Design Principles	Tier 2 & Tier 3

AI CONTENT EXTRACTION PROMPTS — READY TO USE

Tier 1 — Build Log Generation

System:	Act as an expert Technical Product Manager and executive career coach.
Prompt:	Review the attached raw project notes regarding [Insert Feature/Decision Name]. Extract the single most compelling technical decision or trade-off mentioned. Draft a highly professional, engaging 200-word Build Log post tailored for LinkedIn. Structure it exactly as follows: 1. THE CHALLENGE — A crisp hook describing the bottleneck. 2. CRITERIA & CONSTRAINTS — The technical or timeline limits. 3. THE CHOICE — The decision made vs. what was rejected. 4. THE SIGNAL — The positive outcome or learning point. Keep the voice authoritative, transparent, and direct. Avoid corporate jargon. Use professional technical vocabulary.

Tier 2 — Insight Pillar Generation

System:	Act as a Senior Product Lead and Lead Writer for top tech publications on Medium and Substack.
Prompt:	Read the attached text blocks, which comprise 3 to 5 independent Build Log entries for [Project Name]. Identify the unifying product development theme across these entries. Generate a structured 800-word Insight Pillar article. Use a compelling title following the style: 'Designing [System Type]: How to Navigate the Trade-offs of [Theme Name]'. Include distinct section subheaders, itemized bullet points, and an explicit framework other Product Managers can copy. The conclusion must highlight analytical rigor and a user-first mindset.

Tier 3 — Executive Case Study Generation

System:	Act as an elite Principal Product Manager and Executive Recruiter.
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Prompt: Read all the uploaded PMD project artifacts for [Project Name]: Problem Statement, Personas, Empathy Map, JTBD, PRD, Wireframe, Retrospective, Launch Plan, and Measure & Iterate Plan. Synthesize this data into a comprehensive Executive Product Case Study optimized for a portfolio website. Organize using these sections: — Executive Summary & Core ROI (metric highlights, 90-second skim target) — Market Opportunity & Problem Validation (discovery journey) — The Architectural Blueprint (tech stack, DB structure, API rationale) — The Engineering Crux & Pivots (where the plan failed and how it recovered) — Outcomes, Analytics & Next Steps (metrics, learnings, future roadmap) Tone: leadership language, end-to-end accountability, metrics alignment, strategic execution. No sanitizing of failures — tradeoffs and pivots are the strongest signal.

TIER-1 BUILD LOG ENTRY CHECKLIST — COMPLETE FOR EVERY POST

Copy and complete this checklist for every single Tier-1 Build Log entry. Completing it before writing ensures every post is recruiter-optimized, maps to a PM competency, and is ready for cross-platform distribution. Store completed checklists in the project's docs/ folder alongside the PMD artifact suite.

1 · Core Structural Elements

- THE CONTEXT — What specific user value or functional mechanism was being built?
- THE CONSTRAINT — What technical, time, API, or architectural limitation was being fought?
- THE DECISION — What exact technical path was chosen, and which viable alternative was actively rejected?
- THE EVIDENCE — Is there an attached artifact? (Code snippet, DB schema, wireframe screenshot, performance metric)

2 · PM Interview Question Alignment

- Does this post implicitly answer a standard PM interview question?
Examples: 'Tell me about a time you managed technical trade-offs'
'How do you handle feature prioritization under constraint?'
'Describe a time your initial approach failed and what you did'
- Tag the competency category: Technical Strategy · Discovery · Execution · UX

3 · Distribution Setup

- Platform hook crafted for LinkedIn — first 100 characters optimized to stop scrolling
- Platform hook crafted for X.com — thread opener or standalone tweet variant
- Keywords inserted naturally for cross-platform profile SEO
- Relevant tool hashtags identified (e.g., #Supabase #React #ProductManagement)
- Call to Action (CTA) appended at the bottom of each platform variant

4 · Aggregation Tracking

- This post filed in the correct raw material bucket (Decision / Failure / Metric / User)
- Running count updated — after 3 posts in the same theme, draft the Tier-2 Insight Pillar
- Post linked from the on-site project changelog if site is live

THE 40-TOPIC CONTENT MENU — TIER-1 IDEATION

Category A Technical Strategy & Architecture

Demonstrates that you speak the language of engineering and understand technical trade-offs

- 01 · Tech Stack Justification — Why a language or framework was chosen for scalability vs. speed
- 02 · API Design Decisions — Choosing between REST, GraphQL, or WebSockets for specific data models
- 03 · Database Schema Architecture — Explaining relational logic or document nesting schemas
- 04 · Security & Identity Management — How authentication, authorization, or data privacy was implemented
- 05 · Technical Debt Lifecycle — Knowingly choosing a quick fix with a documented refactor strategy
- 06 · Build vs. Buy Decisions — Third-party API integrations vs. writing proprietary software
- 07 · Environment Parity — Strategy for maintaining Dev, Staging, and Production consistency
- 08 · Automated Testing Matrix — Why specific unit, integration, or E2E tests were prioritized
- 09 · Containerization Logic — The why and how of Docker for environment stability
- 10 · Performance Optimization — Pinpointing a system latency bottleneck and deploying the fix

Category B Product Discovery & Validation

Proves that you build things that solve verified problems — not just software built blindly

- 11 · Problem Statement Refinement — How the underlying problem evolved after user or data research
- 12 · Persona Boundary Conditions — A user scenario that directly changed a core feature's logic
- 13 · Competitor Gap Analysis — A feature added or removed based on thorough market benchmarking
- 14 · Assumption Mapping Matrix — Identifying and de-risking the single most critical MVP assumption
- 15 · User Journey Optimization — The structural logic behind a multi-step onboarding flow
- 16 · Feature Prioritization Rigor — Using RICE, MoSCoW, or Kano to aggressively cut MVP scope
- 17 · Unhappy Path & Edge Cases — How systemic recovery models were built for errors and edge cases
- 18 · Qualitative Feedback Loops — When early user feedback completely inverted a UI hypothesis
- 19 · Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD) Map — Articulating the exact underlying customer job a feature accomplishes
- 20 · MVP Hard Constraints — Defining the precise boundary where Minimum safely meets Viable

Category C Execution & Process (SDLC)

Focuses on operational efficiency, agile practices, and the ability to ship robust products safely

- 21 · Git Workflow Protocols — Branch naming, trunk protection, and pull request review systems
- 22 · CI/CD Pipeline Breakdown — Deployment automation structure and pipeline break post-mortems
- 23 · Documentation Strategy — Clean README, internal wikis, or OpenAPI/Swagger spec design
- 24 · Sprint Retrospective Analytics — What self-imposed velocity metrics taught during iterations
- 25 · Dependency Risk Management — Handling a broken, outdated, or insecure open-source package
- 26 · Bug Triage Matrix — How Severity vs. Priority is defined systematically during crunch phases
- 27 · Efficiency Tooling Choices — Why specific IDE extensions, CLI agents, or scripts were integrated
- 28 · State Management Logic — Managing complex reactive states (multiplayer sync, global cart)
- 29 · Schema & Data Migrations — Logical steps taken to migrate production databases without data loss
- 30 · Release Notes & Changelogs — Translating technical PR lists into value-driven user changelogs

Category D Design & User Experience (UX)

Showcases ability to bridge technical architecture and human interaction

- 31 · Visual System Hierarchy — Why specific UI aesthetics align with user psychology
- 32 · Information Architecture (IA) — How a dashboard was organized to minimize cognitive load
- 33 · Accessibility Guardrails (a11y) — Concrete actions taken to meet WCAG 2.2 AA standards
- 34 · The Empty State Paradigm — Designing high-engagement layouts for zero-data views
- 35 · Graceful Error Messaging — Transforming system errors into actionable, reassuring user copy
- 36 · Micro-interactions — Small visual responses built to delight users and anchor habits
- 37 · Cross-Platform Constraints — Responsive layout trade-offs between desktop and mobile views
- 38 · Typography & Eye-Tracking — Using text weights and visual anchors to drive CTA conversion
- 39 · Microcopy & Taxonomy — How navigation naming decisions reduced user confusion or churn
- 40 · Contextual Iconography — Using universal design indicators to remove language/cultural friction

DISTRIBUTION & PUBLISHING CALENDAR

Tier	Cadence	Operational Focus	LinkedIn Strategy	CTA
1 • Build Log	2–3× per week	Profile impressions • Search recruiter velocity • Niche technical keywords • Community hashtags	Post directly to LinkedIn Feed as Quick Update. First 100 characters must stop the scroll.	'Follow for the next update'
2 • Insight Pillar	1–2× per month	Domain authority • Backlinks • Network credibility • Mid-tail SEO keywords	Publish on Medium/Substack as canonical. Then de-bulk into 5 sequential LinkedIn Feed posts over one week. This is the Hidden SEO tactic.	'Subscribe for deeper dives'
3 • Case Study	Once per portfolio project	Recruiter conversion • Hiring manager depth • High-intent keywords • Resume attachment	Publish on portfolio site as canonical. Share LinkedIn post linking to it. Attach PDF version to job applications and recruiter follow-ups.	'Download the full PDF case study'

THE HIDDEN SEO TACTIC — LinkedIn Profile Authority

For recruiters, the most important SEO is not Google — it is LinkedIn. A recruiter visiting a LinkedIn profile sees recent activity and judges engagement before reading the resume. The tactic: After publishing a Tier-2 Insight Pillar article on Medium or Substack, extract five distinct sub-points from it and publish each as a separate LinkedIn Feed post over five consecutive days. Each post links back to the full article. The result: A recruiter visiting the profile during that week sees five consecutive days of high-quality product thinking. The profile reads as active, deeply invested, and expert-level — from a single article written once.

PMD SYSTEM INTEGRATION — MANDATORY RULES

Every P1–Pn project	Generates at least one Tier-1 Build Log post. The post is drafted at phase close using the session retro as raw material. Minimum: one post per project. Target: one post per completed phase within the project.
Every phase group close	After completing a phase group (e.g., end of Phase II at P16, end of Phase IV at P30), aggregate the Tier-1 posts from that group and draft one Tier-2 Insight Pillar. The pillar identifies the unifying theme across the group's decisions.
Every portfolio milestone project	Produces one Tier-3 Executive Case Study. The case study is drafted after the project's Phase 9 (Measure & Iterate) is complete and at least 30 days of post-launch data is available. No portfolio project is considered complete without a published Tier-3 case study.
Raw material filing	All session notes are categorized into the four Artifact-to-Draft buckets (Decision / Failure / Metric / User) at the close of every session. Filed in docs/content-log/ within the project repository alongside the PMD artifact suite.
The panic word applies	If content creation begins to feel like a blocker rather than a by-product, invoke 'too much' and the coach will narrow to one single Tier-1 post from the most recent session. Content does not block shipping. Shipping always comes first.

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